5.2.2 Types of Data

On the basis of collection, data are of two types. They are primary data and secondary data.

Primary data

Primary data means the raw data (not tailored data) which has just been collected from the original source and has not gone any kind of statistical treatment like sorting and tabulation.

ACTIVITY

Collect data on the level of literacy of people in your street.

Examples

- List of absentees in the class.
- A survey on writing habits of students conducted by a pen manufacturing company.
- The types of leaves collected by students for studying nature.

Secondary Data

Secondary data consists of second hand information which has already been collected. It could have been collected by someone other than the user, for some other purpose.

Examples

- The Headmaster collects the students' absentee list from school office.
- Cricket scores gathered from a website.
- Data from Television and Newspapers.
- List of contact numbers from telephone directory.

DO YOU KNOW?

Primary data is collected in person and so more reliable than Secondary data.

5.2.3 Organizing Data

The collected data are to be arranged methodically or logically so that the information can be looked up fast whenever needed, easily and efficiently. The method of organizing the data is discussed as follows.

Tally Marks

Consider the data collected by Santhi (given in Table). Is it easy to get the required information from the data? For example, can any one quickly tell the number of people who do not like Laddu? No. So she decides to organize the data (See Fig. 5.2).



Fig.5.2

Her friends come to help her. Malar arranges the data as given below in the table. She uses '✓' marks to note down how many friends like each of the sweets. The count of each sweet is called as "Frequency".

6th_Chapter 5_088-107.indd 91 1/27/2020 2:03:59 PM